

VINAY LAKSHMAN

+33 745534193 | lakshmanvinay@gmail.com | Strasbourg, France
linkedin.com/in/vinay-lakshman

PROFILE

Senior executive with 20 years of CFO and CEO-level leadership in publicly-listed, capital-intensive engineering businesses, now transitioning into the global space sector. Proven track record of driving revenue growth, executing post-acquisition integrations, leading multi-site operations across three continents, and building high-performing teams in automotive and medical-device manufacturing. Currently completing a Master of Space Studies at the International Space University (Strasbourg), specialising in commercial space economics, launch vehicle architecture, mission design, and orbital venture finance. Co-founded a SATCOM-focused deep-tech startup bridging satellite connectivity with terrestrial mobility. Seeking senior leadership roles in operations, strategy, finance, or business development within the space industry—bringing two decades of industrial rigour to a sector defined by rapid scaling, capital discipline, and technical complexity.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Grew revenue 27% (from €44M to €56M) and doubled operating profitability (5% to 10%) as CEO of a publicly-listed automotive component manufacturer serving global OEMs.
- Led cross-border post-acquisition integration of a European manufacturing subsidiary, aligning financial reporting, operations, and commercial systems across US and Swiss operations.
- Tripled R&D; investment from 2.5% to 8.5% of revenue, funding next-generation braking technologies and securing new OEM platform wins—a model directly applicable to space-sector technology scaling.
- Managed \$60M global inventory across multi-site manufacturing of high-reliability, FDA-regulated medical devices—supply-chain complexity comparable to launch-hardware production.
- Achieved re-certification of the Deming Grand Prize (Japan), the highest quality recognition in global manufacturing.
- Architected business cases for SATCOM-based Over-the-Air (OTA) update architectures, pitching ROI frameworks to global automotive OEMs evaluating satellite versus terrestrial data backhaul.
- Advised Fortune 500 clients (Google, The Gap, Washington Mutual) on risk management and governance at KPMG, building multi-stakeholder advisory relationships across industries.
- Deep Space Communication Roadmap research funded by the John Templeton Foundation (ISU).

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Corporate Strategy & Capital Allocation | P&L; Ownership & Revenue Growth | Financial Planning & Analysis (FP&A;) | Post-Acquisition Integration | Multi-Site Operations Management | B2B Technical Sales & OEM Account Management | SATCOM & Space Connectivity Business Models | Commercial Space Economics & Launch Vehicle Architecture | Mission Design & Orbital Mechanics | Enterprise Risk Management & Compliance (SOX, IFRS, Indian GAAP) | Board-Level Reporting & Investor Relations | Cross-Border Contract Negotiation | Team Building & Organisational Transformation | SEBI/NSE Regulatory Compliance

WORK EXPERIENCE

ENGINECAL PRIVATE LIMITED, BANGALORE, INDIA (START-UP)

JAN 2023 – PRESENT

Financial Architect & Co-Founder (Strategic Lead) – Leading financial and technical feasibility modelling for AI-driven vehicle intelligence platforms, with a focus on integrating satellite connectivity into terrestrial mobility ecosystems.

- Architected the business case and financial structure for SATCOM-based Over-the-Air (OTA) update architectures, evaluating the ROI of satellite versus terrestrial data backhaul for global automotive OEMs.
- Developed complex valuation models and risk-adjusted return frameworks for deep-tech AI investments, ensuring alignment with long-term commercial space connectivity trends.
- Led customer discovery and market validation across automotive OEMs and satellite operators, identifying addressable market segments for SATCOM-enabled vehicle platforms.
- Designed the "Verticalization" roadmap for the company's expansion, including cost-modelling for data-processing centres and on-board AI hardware integration.
- Secured early-stage investor interest through structured investment proposals and pitch presentations to angel networks and institutional funds.

RANE BRAKE LIMITED, CHENNAI, INDIA (NSE-LISTED)

SEP 2014 – JAN 2020

CEO & Managing Director – Full P&L; responsibility for a publicly-listed automotive component manufacturer (subsidiary of the €800M Rane Group), producing advanced braking systems for global OEMs including Honda, Ford, and Daimler affiliates.

- Designed and executed the company's multi-year strategic plan, aligning product development, manufacturing capability, and capital investment with evolving global automotive market demands.
- Grew revenue 27% from €44M to €56M by winning new OEM platform contracts, expanding the customer base across India, Europe, and Asia, and deepening share-of-wallet with existing accounts.
- Doubled operating profitability from 5% to 10% through operational efficiency improvements, product mix optimisation, and disciplined pricing strategy.
- Tripled R&D; investment from 2.5% to 8.5% of revenue to fund next-generation braking technologies and long-term product innovation—directly relevant to technology-scaling challenges in space hardware.
- Led cross-border commercial negotiations with major global OEMs, managing multi-year supply agreements, pricing frameworks, and technical qualification programmes.
- Drove the company's energy transition roadmap, increasing renewable energy use from 18% to 40% and reducing power costs as a percentage of revenue.
- Strengthened operational excellence and quality governance, achieving re-certification of the Deming Grand Prize (Japan)—the highest quality recognition in global manufacturing.
- Built and mentored a high-performing leadership team across commercial, engineering, and manufacturing functions.
- Represented the company at international trade shows, OEM technology days, and industry forums; hosted VIP customer delegations at manufacturing facilities.
- Certified as a Great Place to Work, improving employee engagement and talent retention across the organisation.

THORATEC CORPORATION, CALIFORNIA, USA

APR 2009 – SEP 2014

Finance & Operations Director – Directed operational finance and strategic planning for a medical-device manufacturer specialising in advanced heart-assist systems (LVAD) and circulatory support technologies—high-value, mission-critical hardware sold to hospitals and health systems globally.

- Led the five-year strategic planning process supporting executive leadership and Board of Directors decision-making on growth investments, market expansion, and product-portfolio strategy.
- Designed and executed post-acquisition systems implementation for a European manufacturing subsidiary (Zurich), enhancing financial reporting accuracy and enabling improved operational and performance analytics.
- Directed operational finance for two manufacturing facilities in California and Zurich producing high-reliability medical devices under stringent FDA and EU regulatory requirements.
- Led the company-wide operating plan and forecasting process, integrating revenue, gross margin, and operating expense planning across global operations.
- Managed \$60M global inventory across multi-site manufacturing operations, improving supply chain visibility and cost control for complex, regulated hardware.

- Established an enterprise risk framework and managed internal audits, reporting directly to the Audit Committee of the Board of Directors under Sarbanes-Oxley and IFRS compliance requirements.
- Interfaced with regulatory bodies on export-control and international trade compliance for cross-border medical device distribution.

KPMG LLP, CALIFORNIA, USA

OCT 2005 – APR 2009

Senior Associate, Risk Advisory – Advised large multinational clients on internal audit, risk management, and governance frameworks as part of the firm's Risk Advisory practice.

- Delivered advisory engagements for Fortune 500 clients including Google, The Gap, and Washington Mutual, covering internal audit design, risk assessment, and Sarbanes-Oxley compliance.
- Developed multi-stakeholder advisory relationships and managed complex client engagements across technology, retail, and financial services industries.
- Built governance frameworks and internal control structures aligned with SOX, IFRS, and industry-specific regulatory requirements.

TRW AUTOMOTIVE, USA

JUL 2002 – JAN 2003

Senior Financial Analyst – Supported financial planning and analysis at a global supplier of automotive safety systems and components for major OEMs worldwide. Analysed product-line profitability, programme pricing, and competitive positioning across international markets.

RANE GROUP, INDIA

FEB 2001 – JUN 2002

Senior Associate – Developed marketing strategy and business development plans for a publicly-listed (NSE India) automotive component group. Identified new market segments, conducted competitive analysis, and supported OEM partnership development.

ARTHUR ANDERSEN LLP, INDIA

JUL 1997 – JAN 2001

Senior Consultant – Delivered audit, tax, and advisory engagements for multinational corporations at one of the world's largest professional services firms. Built client relationships and managed cross-functional engagement teams across diverse industries.

EDUCATION

International Space University (ISU), Strasbourg, France

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

Master of Space Studies (MSS)

Commercial Space Strategy & Economics | Mission Design | Launch Vehicle Architecture | Orbital Mechanics | Space Project Management | Model-Based Systems Engineering (MBSE) | AI for Earth Observation & Remote Sensing | 1U CubeSat Design, Integration & Testing | Deep Space Communication Roadmap (John Templeton Foundation Grant)

Arsha Vidya Gurukulam, India

2020 – 2022

Executive Sabbatical – Indian Philosophy & Analytical Thinking

Completed a two-year immersive programme in analytical philosophy, formal logic, and systems-thinking at a traditional residential centre of learning. Developed a disciplined, first-principles approach to decision-making and ethical governance applicable to high-stakes leadership environments.

Keller Graduate School of Management, DeVry University, Chicago, IL

2003 – 2005

Master of Accounting and Financial Management

Indian Institute of Chartered Accountants

1997 – 2001

Certified (Inter) Chartered Accountant

Loyola College, University of Madras, India

1994 – 1997

Bachelor of Commerce